

EU and NATO Enlargement Puzzles

Ivan Katchanovski, Ph.D.

Visiting Scholar
Davis Center for Russian and Eurasian Studies
Harvard University
1730 Cambridge Street
Cambridge, MA 02138, USA
(Until May 31, 2010)

Part-time Professor
School of Political Studies
University of Ottawa
55 Laurier Avenue East
Ottawa, ON, K1N 6N5
Canada
ikatchan@uottawa.ca
(From September 7, 2010)

Paper prepared for presentation at the Annual Meeting of the American Political Science Association in Washington, DC, September 2-5, 2010

Abstract

Enlargements of the European Union (EU) and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) present major puzzles. While many post-communist countries, such as Poland, the Czech Republic, Romania, Bulgaria, Bosnia, Albania, and the Baltic States were granted a membership or a prospect of membership in these organizations, a number of post-communist countries located in Europe, such as Russia, Belarus, Moldova, and Azerbaijan, were not offered prospects of membership even when they would satisfy official criteria for joining the EU and NATO. Some countries, such as Ukraine and Georgia, were officially recognized as potential members of NATO, but not the European Union. The question is, which factors account for such significant variation in the accession to the EU and NATO among European post-communist countries. Previous studies explained the exclusion of certain post-communist countries by their failure to meet such formal and informal EU membership criteria as having a liberal democracy, a European location and identity, a Western Christian religious tradition, a high level of economic development, a relatively small population size, and popular as well as government support from the EU's prospective and most influential existing members. Similarly, NATO accession studies emphasized such criteria as democracy, peaceful resolution of internal ethnic conflicts or territorial disputes, and the ability to meet NATO military standards. This paper uses comparative and multiple regression analysis to determine which factors affect the European Union and NATO membership of 25 European post-communist countries. The EU accession index and the NATO accession index are derived from the status of each country as a member, as a candidate, as a potential candidate, and as a non-member/not a potential candidate. Such factors, as the level of democracy, the economic level of development, religion, post-Soviet region, population size, violent conflicts, and public support for EU or NATO membership, are

analyzed. The study shows that the level of democracy and the economic development level have positive effects on EU accession, while being a post-Soviet country has a negative effect.

Similarly, the level of democracy positively affects NATO accession, but post-Soviet states have a negative likelihood of admission into NATO when all other factors are held constant.

EU and NATO Enlargement Puzzles

Enlargements of the European Union (EU) and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) present major puzzles. Such post-communist countries as Poland, the Czech Republic, Hungary, Slovakia, Romania, Bulgaria, Slovenia, Estonia, Latvia, and Lithuania became members of both the EU and NATO. Albania and Croatia joined NATO, but their accession to the EU lagged behind. These two countries along with Serbia, Macedonia, Montenegro, Bosnia, and Kosovo were recognized by the European Commission as either candidate countries or potential candidates. Bosnia, Macedonia, Montenegro, and Serbia achieved similar status in their accession to NATO. Ukraine and Georgia were officially recognized as potential members of NATO, but not the European Union. In contrast, many other post-communist countries located fully or partly in Europe, such as Russia, Belarus, Moldova, Azerbaijan, and Kazakhstan, were not even offered prospects of membership in these organizations in the future when they were to satisfy all official criteria for joining the EU and NATO.

Which factors account for such significant variation in the accession of the EU and NATO among European post-communist countries? Researchers and policy-makers explained the exclusion of certain post-communist countries by their failure to meet such formal and informal EU membership criteria as having a liberal democracy, a European location and identity, a Western Christian religion, a high level of economic development, a relatively small population size, and popular support as well as government support from the EU's prospective and most influential existing members. Similarly, NATO accession studies emphasized such criteria as democracy, peaceful resolution of violent internal ethnic conflicts or territorial disputes, and the ability to meet NATO military standards.

Previous studies primarily examined accession or non-accession of individual post-communist countries or relatively small groups of these countries. For instance, Grabbe concluded that, “Belarus is too authoritarian, Moldova too poor, Ukraine too large, and Russia too scary for the EU to contemplate offering membership any time soon.”¹ Quantitative analysis of determinants of accession of all post-communist states that qualified or can potentially qualify for EU and NATO membership is lacking. (See, for example, Schimmelfennig and Sedelmeier, 2005).

The Maastricht Treaty, adopted in 1992, specifies that any European country which respects principles set by the EU may apply to become its member.² In 1993, the European Council adopted the “Copenhagen criteria.” To gain an EU membership, candidates are required to satisfy the following criteria:

stability of institutions guaranteeing democracy, the rule of law, human rights and respect for and protection of minorities, the existence of a functioning market economy as well as the capacity to cope with competitive pressure and market forces within the Union. Membership presupposes the candidate’s ability to take on the obligations of membership including adherence to the aims of political, economic and monetary union. The Union’s capacity to absorb new members, while maintaining the momentum of European integration, is also an important consideration in the general interest of both the Union and the candidate countries.³

Similarly, the Washington Treaty, which was adopted by founding members of NATO in 1949, states that “the Parties may, by unanimous agreement, invite any other European State in a position to further the principles of this Treaty and to contribute to the security of the North Atlantic area to accede to this Treaty.”⁴ In 1995, the North Atlantic Treaty Organization specified in the “Study on NATO Enlargement” that aspiring members of the alliance must be

democracies, peacefully settle ethnic conflicts and territorial disputes, and be able to contribute militarily to NATO.⁵ The “Copenhagen criteria” and the “Study on NATO Enlargement” were issued primarily to formalize accession of potential members among post-communist states in Central and Eastern Europe.

Some studies argue that there is a reverse causation in the relationship between the level of democracy and European Union accession. Prospects of EU membership promote democratization of post-communist countries because existence of democratic institutions is a precondition for joining the European Union (See Schimmelfennig and Scholtz., 2010; Way and Levitsky, 2007). However, these studies fail to explain why the market economy conditionality in European Union accession did not have a similar effect. All European post-communist countries, both EU aspirants and countries that are not recognized as potential candidates, transformed their state-controlled centrally planned economies into market economies. Other studies show that NATO accession does not promote democratization in spite of similar democracy conditionality in joining this organization (see, for example, Reiter, 2001).

In addition, weak support among the public and the ruling elite in such post-communist countries as Russia, Belarus, and Ukraine is often cited by scholars and policy-makers as another factor hindering their EU and NATO accession (See, for example, White, McAllister, Light, and Löwenhardt, 2002). However, survey data show that the absolute majorities, excluding the undecided, of Russians, Belarusians, and Ukrainians consistently and by wide margins supported EU membership of their countries in the 2000s (Katchanovski, 2008; White, McAllister, and Feklyunina, 2010). Popular opinion concerning NATO membership in Russia, Belarus, and Ukraine varied significantly after the collapse of communism. Public opposition to NATO membership in Russia and Belarus following the NATO-led war in Kosovo and in Ukraine since

the US-led war in Iraq 2003 outweighed support for joining the alliance, but public opinion on this issue in these post-Soviet states following 9/11 was either split more evenly or relatively favorable. (See Katchanovski, 2008; McAllister and White, 2002; White, McAllister, and Feklyunina, 2010).

Russian President Boris Yeltsin in 1991 and President Vladimir Putin in 2000 both voiced their desire to join NATO. Belarus, Armenia, and Kazakhstan were likely to follow Russia in joining NATO since they were Russia's allies. Even though the Russian government did not express interest in becoming a member of the European Union, President Putin stated that he would have been pleased if Russia were to get an invitation to join this organization since he considered Russians to be culturally and mentally European.⁶ EU membership was backed by the last three presidents of Ukraine. While Victor Yanukovych officially renounced President Yushchenko's goal of joining NATO after becoming President of Ukraine in 2010, Yanukovych and his Party of Regions supported President Kuchma's declaration to seek such a membership in 2002.

The Georgian government after the "Rose Revolution" in 2004 made EU and NATO membership one of its major foreign policy priorities, and the majority of public, excluding secessionist regions of Abkhazia and South Ossetia, supported this goal. In Moldova, excluding the secessionist Transdniestrian Republic, EU and NATO memberships were backed by the absolute majority of people (White, McAllister, Light, and Löwenhardt, 2002; McAllister and White, 2002). The ruling coalition, which came to power in Moldova after the July 2009 parliamentary elections, called itself the Alliance for European Integration to emphasize its foreign policy priorities. Kazakhstan and Armenian officials expressed potential interest in EU

membership for their countries. Polls show that the Armenia public supported the EU integration.⁷

However, the European Union, and most leaders of its major member-countries, opposed not only membership to these post-Soviet states, but also even formal recognition of the right of these countries to join this organization in the future when they would fulfill all formal requirements for membership.⁸ For example, European Union's Foreign Affairs Commissioner Javier Solana stated in 2009 that Ukraine would not become an EU member in the foreseeable future, in contrast to Albania.⁹ Similarly, NATO refused to acknowledge the right of Russia and other post-Soviet states, with the exceptions of the Baltic States and Ukraine and Georgia, to join this organization.

Such policy of exclusion of certain post-communist countries and integration of other post-communist states represents a major puzzle for other reasons. Lasas (2010) argues that EU and NATO integration of post-communist countries was ideologically driven and presented restitution to these countries for the 1938 Munich Agreement, the 1939 Soviet-Nazi pact, and the 1945 Yalta-Potsdam conferences. However, this theory cannot explain the exclusion of such post-communist countries as Ukraine, Moldova and Belarus from the same waves of EU and NATO enlargement since these post-Soviet countries were also affected by the Soviet-Nazi pact. In addition, the historical restitution theory fails to explain why the restitution centers on these particular World War II related agreements and ignores World War II itself. It is puzzling that major powers of NATO and/or the EU, such as the US, the UK, and France, were reluctant to encourage NATO or EU membership of Soviet successor countries, such as Russia, Ukraine, and Belarus, which were allied with them during the war and experienced Nazi-led genocide, and

instead would reward such countries as Hungary, Romania, Bulgaria, Slovakia, and Croatia that assisted Nazi Germany in conducting an aggressive genocidal war.

EU and NATO memberships for the post-Soviet countries would have not only offered economic, political, and security benefits to these countries, but also to members of the European Union and NATO since the former Soviet Union and its successor states played a crucial role in the end of communism and the Cold War. In addition, Ukraine, Belarus, and Kazakhstan voluntarily renounced nuclear weapons that were left after the collapse of the Soviet Union, while Russia significantly reduced its nuclear arsenal. These ongoing benefits to EU and NATO members outweigh potential future costs of accession of the European post-Soviet states. Moreover, the exclusion of these states from the EU and NATO enlargement creates an economically, politically, and militarily divided Europe.

In addition, prospective members of the European Union and NATO could have promoted the peaceful resolution of conflicts involving the secessionist states of Chechnya in Russia, Transdniestria in Moldova, South Ossetia and Abkhazia in Georgia, and Nagorno Karabakh in Azerbaijan. Conflict resolution considerations were offered as a rationale for EU and NATO accession of the Balkan states, such as Bosnia, Serbia, Macedonia, and Kosovo. For example, the European Union declared Kosovo as its potential member even though this secessionist state was not recognized by some EU members, such as Spain and Romania. In contrast, the EU did not offer such prospects to similar secessionist states of Transdniestria, South Ossetia, Abkhazia, and Nagorno Karabakh.

Hypotheses

This paper uses comparative and multiple regression analyses to determine which factors affect the EU and NATO membership status of 25 post-communist countries that are considered fully or partly European. It tests several hypotheses which are based both on official criteria of the enlargement of these organizations and on previous studies which identified other factors of EU and NATO accession. The first hypothesis is that the level of democracy is a major factor of EU and NATO accession of the post-communist states. For example, EU and NATO memberships of such countries as Poland, Hungary, the Czech Republic, and Slovenia were often attributed to their democratic political systems after the collapse of communism.

The second hypothesis is that religious tradition affects the membership prospects in EU and NATO. Both these organizations are often associated with Western civilization since they were founded by Western countries. Western civilization is frequently equated with Western Christianity (Huntington, 1996). The clash of civilizations theory implies that predominantly Protestant and Catholic post-communist nations have significantly better prospects for NATO accession compared to Muslim or Orthodox Christian countries. Because of NATO involvement in the war in Afghanistan and the US- and UK- led invasion of Iraq, NATO is often perceived as being hostile to Muslim countries in spite of a NATO-led war in support of the Kosovo Albanians. Similarly, prejudice against Muslims is often cited as a major factor that hinders Turkey's membership in the European Union.

The third hypothesis tested in this study states that Russia and other post-Soviet countries are discriminated against in terms of EU and NATO accession because of lingering anti-Russian prejudice in many of their major member-countries that exercise most influence on the enlargement process. Western perceptions, particularly American and British perceptions, and policies towards the Russian Empire and the Soviet Union historically were often very

negative and irrational (See Davis and Trani, 2009; Malia, 1999). This bias, which goes back to the times of the Russian Empire and the Cold War, manifested itself in post-Cold war policy towards Russia of such countries as the United States and the United Kingdom. (See Lieven, 2000; Tsygankov, 2009). The anti-Russian bias extends to post-Soviet countries since they, like the Soviet Union and the Russian Empire, are often associated in the West with Russia. The Baltic States are exceptions because they were perceived as distinct from Russia, both at the time of the Soviet Union and in the post-Soviet period.

Comparative analysis of survey data show that, on average, EU and NATO accession of post-Soviet countries, excluding the Baltic States, receives less public support in leading members of these organizations than the accession of other post-communist nations. For example, in the 2009 Pew Research Center's Global Attitudes Project survey, the unweighted average of 61% and 45% of the respondents in the United Kingdom, France, and Germany respectively favored the admittance, of Croatia and Serbia in the European Union in the next ten years. In comparison, 47% and 42% of the respondents in these three leading EU countries backed the EU membership of Ukraine and Georgia, respectively. (Two Decades, 2009, pp. 145-147). In the TNS Sofres Survey in November 2005, the unweighted average of 46% and 42% of the respondents in the UK, France, and Germany respectively backed the EU membership of Ukraine and Russia when they fulfill all conditions for the admission.¹⁰ Similarly, the 1998 Attitudes on Transatlantic Issues Survey showed that 51% and 57% of Americans supported the NATO membership of Russia and Ukraine, while 41% and 30% opposed (respectively). In comparison, the unweighted average of 62% favored and 26% opposed the admission of Bulgaria, Romania, Slovakia, the Czech Republic, Hungary, and Poland.

The European Union is often implicitly or explicitly equated with Europe. Europe is frequently defined as a continent with no clear eastern borders (See, for instance, Pagden, 2002). Such post-Soviet countries as Russia, Ukraine, Moldova, Belarus Kazakhstan, Georgia, Azerbaijan, and Armenia, are often regarded as non-European in terms of their location and identity, and consequently ineligible for EU and NATO memberships. For example, TNS Sofres Survey in March 2005 showed that only 44% of the respondents in the UK, 54% in Germany, and 63% in France consider Ukraine to be a part of Europe geographically, historically, and culturally, while 27% in the UK, 39% in Germany, and 32% in France regard Ukraine as non-European.¹¹

However, Turkey, which has a small fraction of its territory and population in Europe, was accepted into NATO, and it was granted official candidate status by the EU in contrast to Russia and Kazakhstan, which are also located partly in Europe. The European Union accepted Greek-populated Cyprus as its member although Cyprus is often located in Asia and not Europe. Likewise, Armenia, Azerbaijan, and Georgia are variously included geographically into Europe or Asia or, in the case of Georgia and Azerbaijan, a small part of their territory is often located in Europe.

In addition, the post-Soviet states are already members of other European organizations. Russia, Ukraine, Moldova, Armenia, Azerbaijan, and Georgia are members of the Council of Europe, and the right of Kazakhstan as a partly European country to join the Council of Europe is officially recognized by this organization. All of these post-Soviet countries, along with Belarus, are also participating states of the Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe. As noted, the issue of European or non-European location of Georgia did not prevent NATO from officially recognizing this post-Soviet state as its potential member.

Survey data show that European identity is embraced by a significant percentage of people in Russia, Ukraine, Moldova, and Belarus. For example, the proportion of the respondents who thought of themselves to at least some extent as European ranged in the 2000s between one-quarter and one-half in Russia, between one-third and one-half in Belarus, and between one-quarter and one-third in Ukraine (White, McAllister, and Feklyunina, 2010). The levels of European self-identification in these post-Soviet nations are comparable to many EU members. For example, the 2009 Pew Research Center's Global Attitudes Project survey demonstrates that the proportion of people in Russia (4%) and Ukraine (6%) who think of themselves first as European is not radically different from such EU members as Hungary (4%), the Czech Republic and Lithuania (6%), the United Kingdom (7%), and Bulgaria and Poland (8%) (Two Decades, 2009, p. 145).

Another hypothesis tested in this study is that the level of economic development is a significant predictor of both EU and NATO enlargement among post-communist countries. Potential members with high levels of GDP per capita require less economic aid from the European Union. Similarly, post-communist countries with a higher level of economic development are more likely to satisfy the NATO condition of being able to contribute militarily.

Other factors that are considered in this study are specific to the particular organization. Violent internal and external conflicts after the collapse of communism are expected to affect negatively accession to NATO. The population size is likely to be a negative factor in the EU enlargement since EU governance gives weight to its member countries according to their population size. Because of their rational self-interest, existing EU members would be much more reluctant to support accession of countries with a large population than countries with a small population.

Data

Accession to the European Union and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization is a lengthy process involving various steps. Therefore, the integration of post-communist countries into these organizations is measured with the help of indexes that reflect each major step of the accession. The EU accession index and the NATO accession index are derived from the status of each country as a member, an official candidate, an official potential candidate, and non-member/not potential candidate as of August 2010. The NATO accession index ranges from 0 (non-member and not officially recognized by NATO as a potential candidate) to 3 (member-country). A country which is formally recognized as a potential future member of NATO or offered an “Intensified Dialogue” is given score of 1. An official candidate country that was offered a “Membership Action Plan” has a score of 2 in the NATO accession index. Similarly, the EU accession index measures status of each post-communist country as a “non-member/not potential candidate” (0), a “potential candidate recognized by the European Commission” (1), an “official candidate” (2), and a “member of the European Union” (3). (See Table 1).

The EU accession index and the NATO accession index are the dependent variables in a multiple regression analysis of the determinants for integration of 25 European post-communist countries into these organizations. The independent variables include the Freedom House democracy index, the GDP per capita, religious composition of the population, the post-Soviet region dummy variable, the Baltic States dummy variable, the population size, and the violent internal and external conflicts since 1991 dummy variable. (See Table 2).

[Table 1 and 2 about here]

Multivariate analysis

The multiple regression analysis shows that the level of democracy has a positive effect on the NATO accession of the 25 post-communist countries. This variable is the biggest determinant of the NATO enlargement since it has the biggest standardized regression coefficient, and it is statistically significant at the .05 level. Predominantly Western Christian or Muslim countries do not differ significantly from other post-communist countries in their NATO accession. The level of economic development and recent or ongoing violent conflicts do not have statistically significant effects on the NATO accession index. In contrast, European post-Soviet countries, excluding the Baltic States, have a negative likelihood of admission into NATO when the other factors are held constant. (Table 3).

Similarly, the level of democracy positively affects the EU accession of the European post-communist states. This variable is statistically significant at the .1 level only in one regression model, and the size of its effect on the European Union enlargement is smaller compared to the level of economic development and the post-Soviet dummy variable. The democracy level becomes a statistically significant predictor of the EU accession in both regression models when the Freedom House democracy index of 1993 is used instead of the 2009 democracy index. This indicates that a reverse causation is unlikely to account for the relationship between the EU integration and democracy among the post-communist states. (Table 4).

[Table 3 and 4 about here]

The level of the GDP per capita, measured in purchasing power parity, positively affects EU integration, while being a post-Soviet state has a negative effect on European Union accession. The post-Soviet variable has the biggest effect on the EU accession index. Its standardized regression coefficient is the largest, and this variable is statistically significant at the .01 level. Being a predominantly Western Christian or Muslim country does not affect the

European Union enlargement.¹² The population size is also a statistically insignificant determinant of EU accession. (See Table 4).

There is no significant multicollinearity problem in the regression analysis. The highest correlation coefficient among the independent variables is between the Freedom House index of democracy in 2009 and the post-Soviet dummy variable (-.77). Both of these variables are statistically significant in two NATO and one EU accession regression models.

Conclusion

The enlargements of the European Union and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization produced major puzzles that are examined in this paper. While many post-communist countries were granted a membership or a prospect of membership in these organizations, many other European post-communist countries were not offered EU and NATO membership or prospects of membership even when they satisfied official criteria for joining these organizations. Previous studies explained the exclusion of certain post-communist countries by their failure to meet such formal and informal EU and NATO membership criteria of having a democracy, a market economy, a European location or identity, Western Christianity, a high level of economic development, popular and government support of prospective members and major existing members, a small population size in the case of EU accession, and a peaceful resolution of internal ethnic conflicts or territorial disputes in case of NATO accession.

This paper used comparative and multiple regression analysis to examine factors which explain these puzzles of the European Union and NATO enlargements. The comparative analysis shows that popular opinion in major EU and NATO members is, on average, less supportive of admitting the post-Soviet countries, excluding the Baltic States, compared to other post-

communist countries. In contrast, the majorities of the respondents and governments in the post-Soviet nations back the EU membership of their countries, while the support for NATO accession among the public and the governments of the post-Soviet was generally much lower and more volatile.

The multivariate analysis shows that the level of democracy has positive effects on the EU and NATO accession of 25 European post-communist countries. Being a post-Soviet country, excluding the Baltic States, has a negative effect on both the European Union and NATO accessions when all other factors are held constant. The level of economic development positively affects the EU integration. Other factors, such as predominantly Western Christian or Muslim religious tradition, the population size in the case of the EU, and the violent internal or external conflicts in the case of NATO, are not statistically significant predictors of the accession.

In contrast to other post-communist countries in Europe, European post-Soviet states, with the exception of the Baltic States, face bleak prospects of the European Union and NATO integration even when they would satisfy all official criteria for the EU and NATO accession. This study implies that Europe is likely to remain divided in the foreseeable future, since many European post-Soviet countries, such as Russia, Ukraine, Belarus, Moldova, and Georgia, are de-facto excluded from NATO and/or European Union enlargement.

Table 1. NATO and EU accession of European post-communist states

Country	NATO accession index	EU accession index
Albania	3	1
Armenia	0	0
Azerbaijan	0	0
Belarus	0	0
Bosnia-Herzegovina	2	1
Bulgaria	3	3
Croatia	3	2
Czech Republic	3	3
Estonia	3	3
Georgia	1	0
Hungary	3	3
Kazakhstan	0	0
Kosovo	0	1
Latvia	3	3
Lithuania	3	3
Macedonia	2	2
Moldova	0	0
Montenegro	1	1
Poland	3	3
Romania	3	3
Russia	0	0
Serbia	1	1
Slovakia	3	3
Slovenia	3	3
Ukraine	1	0

Table 2. Independent variables of EU and NATO accession

Country	Freedom House Democracy Index 2009*	GDP per capita 2009 (ppp), \$**	Western Christians, %***	Muslim country ***	Post- Soviet state	Baltic States	Violent conflicts	Population 2008, million****
Albania	6	7164	10	1	0	0	0	3.1
Armenia	10	4966	0	0	1	0	1	3.1
Azerbaijan	11	9564	0	1	1	0	1	8.7
Belarus	13	12737	14	0	1	0	0	9.7
Bosnia-Herzegovina	7	7361	19	1	0	0	1	3.8
Bulgaria	4	11900	1	0	0	0	0	7.6
Croatia	3	17703	77	0	0	0	1	4.4
Czech Republic	2	24093	44	0	0	0	0	10.4
Estonia	2	17908	68	0	0	1	0	1.3
Georgia	8	4757	0	0	1	0	1	4.4
Hungary	2	18567	93	0	0	0	0	10
Kazakhstan	11	11693	5	1	1	0	0	15.7
Kosovo	9	2500	0	1	0	0	1	2.1
Latvia	3	14255	63	0	0	1	0	2.3
Lithuania	2	16542	70	0	0	1	0	3.4
Macedonia	6	9171	0	0	0	0	1	2
Moldova	7	2843	0	0	1	0	1	3.6
Montenegro	5	10393	4	0	0	0	0	0.6
Poland	2	18072	95	0	0	0	0	38.1
Romania	4	11917	12	0	0	0	0	21.5
Russia	11	14920	0	0	1	0	1	141.8
Serbia	4	10635	7	0	0	0	1	7.4
Slovakia	2	21244	68	0	0	0	0	5.4
Slovenia	2	27654	72	0	0	0	0	2
Ukraine	5	6339	15	0	1	0	0	46.3

* *Freedom in the World* (2010). ** IMF (2010); data for Kosovo are estimated from *World Factbook* (2009). *** La Porta, Lopez-de-

Silanes, Shleifer, and Vishny (1999). **** World Bank (2010).

Table 3. Determinants of NATO accession of European post-communist countries, OLS regressions

	Model 1			Model 2		
	Regression coefficient	Standard error	Beta (standardized regression coefficient)	Regression coefficient	Standard error	Beta (standardized regression coefficient)
GDP per capita	0.000	0.000	0.072	0.000	0.000	0.126
Freedom House Democracy Index	0.164**	0.072	0.432	0.180**	0.075	0.473
Proportion of Western Christians	0.004	0.007	0.106			
Muslim country				-0.027	0.416	-0.008
Post-Soviet country	-0.913**	0.417	-0.327	-0.896*	0.445	-0.320
Baltic State	0.052	0.432	0.013	0.128	0.415	0.032
Territorial/ethnic conflict	-0.380	0.310	-0.143	-0.372	0.321	-0.140
Constant	2.817***	0.583		2.845***	0.716	
R square	0.84			0.84		
N	25			25		

Note: The Freedom House index is reversed. *** Statistically significant at the .01 level;

** statistically significant at the .05 level; * statistically significant at the .10 level.

Table 4. Determinants of EU accession of European post-communist countries, OLS regressions

	Model 1			Model 2		
	Regression coefficient	Standard error	Beta (standardized regression coefficient)	Regression coefficient	Standard error	Beta (standardized regression coefficient)
GDP per capita	0.000**	0.000	0.317	0.000***	0.000	0.322
Freedom House Democracy Index	0.112*	0.061	0.297	0.103	0.062	0.273
Proportion of Western Christians	0.000	0.006	0.009			
Muslim country				-0.124	0.347	-0.035
Post-Soviet country	-1.146***	0.369	-0.412	-1.181***	0.379	-0.424
Baltic State	0.505	0.363	0.126	0.511	0.346	0.128
Population size	-0.001	0.004	-0.019	-0.001	0.004	-0.026
Constant	1.688***	0.475		1.547**	0.618	
R square	0.88				0.88	
N	25				25	

Note: The Freedom House index is reversed. *** Statistically significant at the .01 level;

** statistically significant at the .05 level; * statistically significant at the .10 level.

References

- Davis, Donald E. and Eugene P. Trani. 2009. *Distorted Mirrors: Americans and Their Relations with Russia and China in the Twentieth Century*. Columbia: University of Missouri Press.
- Freedom in The World 2010: Erosion of Freedom Intensifies*. 2010. Freedom House, <http://www.freedomhouse.org>.
- Huntington, Samuel. 1996. *The Clash of Civilizations and the Remaking of World Order*. New York: Touchstone.
- IMF. 2010. "World Economic Outlook Database." International Monetary Fund, <http://www.imf.org>.
- Katchanovski, Ivan. 2008. 'The Orange Evolution? The 'Orange Revolution' and Political Changes in Ukraine,' *Post-Soviet Affairs*, 24, 4, pp. 351-382.
- La Porta, Rafael, Florencio Lopez-de-Silanes, Andrei Shleifer, and Vishny, Robert. 1999. "The quality of government." *Journal of Law, Economics and Organization*, 15, 1, pp. 222-279.
- Lasas, Ainius. 2010. *European Union and NATO Expansion. Central and Eastern Europe*. London: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Lieven, Anatol. 2000. "Against Russophobia." *World Policy Journal*, 17, 4, pp. 25-32.
- Malia, Martin. 1999. *Russia Under Western Eyes from the Bronze Horseman to the Lenin Mausoleum*. Cambridge: Harvard University Press.
- McAllister, Ian and Stephen White. 2002. "NATO enlargement and Eastern opinion." *European Security*, 11, 4, pp. 47-58.

- Pagden, Anthony (ed.). 2002. *The Idea of Europe: From Antiquity to the European Union*. Washington: Woodrow Wilson Press.
- Reiter, Dan. 2001. "Why NATO Enlargement Does Not Spread Democracy." *International Security*, 25, 4, pp. 41-67.
- Tsygankov, Andrei P. 2009. *Russophobia: Anti-Russian Lobby and American Foreign Policy*. New York: Palgrave Macmillan.
- "Two Decades After the Wall's Fall. End of Communism Cheered but Now with More Reservations." 2009. Pew Global Attitudes Project, www.pewglobal.org.
- Way, Lucan A. and Steven Levitsky. 2007. "Linkage, Leverage, and the Post-Communist Divide." *East European Politics & Societies*, 21, 1, pp. 48-66.
- White, Stephen, Ian McAllister, and Valentina Feklyunina. 2010. "Belarus, Ukraine and Russia: East or West?" *British Journal of Politics and International Relations* (In press).
- White, Stephen, Ian McAllister, Margot Light, and John Löwenhardt. 2002. "A European or a Slavic Choice? Foreign Policy and Public Attitudes in Post-Soviet Europe," *Europe-Asia Studies*, 54, 2, pp. 181-202.
- Schimmelfennig Frank and Hanno Scholtz. 2010. "Legacies and Leverage: EU Political Conditionality and Democracy Promotion in Historical Perspective." *Europe-Asia Studies*, 62, 3, pp. 443–460.
- Schimmelfennig, Frank and Ulrich Sedelmeier, (eds.). 2005. *The Politics of European Union Enlargement: Theoretical Approaches*. London: Routledge.
- World Bank. 2010. "World Development Indicators database," <http://www.worldbank.org>.

World Factbook 2009. 2009. Central Intelligence Agency,
<http://www.cia.gov/cia/publications/factbook/>.

Notes

¹ Quoted in “Ever-Expanding Union?” *Economist*, April 29, 2004.

² “Consolidated Version of the Treaty on European Union,”

http://eur-lex.europa.eu/en/treaties/dat/12002M/htm/C_2002325EN.000501.html.

³ “European Council in Copenhagen - 21-22 June 1993- Conclusions of the Presidency,”

<http://europa.eu/rapid/pressReleasesAction.do?reference=DOC/93/3&format=HTML&aged=1&language=EN&guiLanguage=en>.

⁴ “The North Atlantic Treaty,”

http://www.nato.int/cps/en/natolive/official_texts_17120.htm.

⁵ “Study on NATO Enlargement,” <http://www.nato.int/docu/basicxt/enl-9501.htm>.

⁶ “Putin byl by schastliv, esli Rossiia poluchit priglashenie v ES,”

http://www.gazeta.ru/lenta/2005/10/31/news_466019.shtml.

⁷ *RFE/RL Caucasus Report*, Radio Free Europe, January 7, 2005.

⁸ In its resolution in 2010, the European Parliament recognized the right of Ukraine to potential membership in the European Union but this resolution was non-binding. (See “European Parliament resolution of 25 February 2010 on the situation in Ukraine,” <http://www.europarl.europa.eu>).

⁹ Javier Solana’s speech at Harvard University, September 17, 2009 (personal observation).

¹⁰ “Europeans and the Accession of Ukraine to the European Union. Wave 2. November 2005,” TNS Sofres, <http://www.tns-sofres.com>.

¹¹ “Europeans and the Accession of Ukraine to the European Union. March 2005,” TNS Sofres, <http://www.tns-sofres.com>.

¹² The main results remain similar when the Western historical legacy dummy variable, which includes post-communist countries that belonged to the Austro-Hungarian and German Empires, is used instead of Western Christianity or Muslim country variables.